

Module 06 Lab - Regression and Classification

ModelsObjective: To understand the difference between

- ✓ regression and classification and to build your first linear models for both tasks.**In this lab, you will write the code to train and evaluate the models.**

Part 1: Regression vs. ClassificationThis is the most fundamental distinction between types of supervised learning problems.*

Regression: The goal is to predict a **continuous numerical value**. *

Examples: Predicting the price of a house, the temperature

tomorrow, or the stock price.* **Classification:** The goal is to predict

a **discrete category or class label**. * *Examples:* Predicting if an

email is spam or not spam, if a flower is a setosa, versicolor, or

virginica, or if a customer will churn or not.**In this lab, we will tackle one of each.**

Part 2: Linear Regression**Concept:** Linear Regression is used to

predict a continuous value. It works by finding the best-fitting

straight line through the data points. The model learns a "slope"

(coefficient) for each feature and an "intercept".* **Problem:** We will

predict the **Fare** of a Titanic passenger based on their **Age** and

Pclass.

```
1 import pandas as pd
2 from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
3 from sklearn.linear_model import LinearRegression
4 from sklearn.metrics import mean_squared_error
5
6 # Load and prepare the data
7 df = pd.read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/datasciencedojo/datasets/master/titanic.csv')
```

```

8
9 # For simplicity, we'll drop rows with missing age
10 df.dropna(subset=['Age'], inplace=True)
11 # Define features and target
12 features = ['Age', 'Pclass']
13 target_reg = 'Fare'
14 X_reg = df[features]
15 y_reg = df[target_reg]
16 # Split the data
17 X_train_reg, X_test_reg, y_train_reg, y_test_reg = train_test_split(X_reg, y_reg, te:

```

- Task 1: Train and Evaluate a Linear Regression Model**Your Task:**1. Create an instance of the `LinearRegression` model.2. Train the model using the training data (`X_train_reg`, `y_train_reg`).3. Make predictions on the test data.4. Evaluate the model using `mean_squared_error`. This metric tells us the average of the squared differences between the predicted and actual values.

```

1 # --- ENTER YOUR CODE HERE ---
2 # 1. Create the model instance
3 import numpy as np
4 lr_model = LinearRegression()
5 # 2. Train the model
6 lr_model.fit(X_train_reg, y_train_reg)
7 # 3. Make predictions
8 y_pred_reg = lr_model.predict(X_test_reg)
9 # 4. Evaluate the model
10 mse = mean_squared_error(y_test_reg, y_pred_reg)
11 print(f"Mean Squared Error for Fare Prediction: {mse:.2f}")
12 print(f"The square root of this is {np.sqrt(mse):.2f}, meaning our model is off by al

```

Mean Squared Error for Fare Prediction: 3364.92

The square root of this is 58.01, meaning our model is off by about \$58.01 on average.

- Part 3: Logistic Regression**Concept:** Despite its name, Logistic Regression is a **classification** algorithm. It works by calculating the probability that a given input belongs to a certain class. It's one of the most widely used and interpretable classification models.*

Problem: We will predict whether a passenger `Survived` based on their `Age`, `Pclass`, and `Sex`.

```

1 from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression
2 from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score
3 # Prepare data for classification# We need to encode 'Sex' column
4 df['Sex'] = df['Sex'].map({'male': 0, 'female': 1})

```

```

5 # Define features and target
6 features_cls = ['Age', 'Pclass', 'Sex']
7 target_cls = 'Survived'
8 X_cls = df[features_cls]
9 y_cls = df[target_cls]
10 # Split the data
11 X_train_cls, X_test_cls, y_train_cls, y_test_cls = train_test_split(X_cls, y_cls, te:

```

Task 2: Train and Evaluate a Logistic Regression Model**Your Task:**1. Create an instance of the `LogisticRegression` model.2. Train the model using the classification training data.3. Make predictions on the test data.4. Evaluate the model using `accuracy_score`.

```

1 # --- ENTER YOUR CODE HERE ---
2 # 1. Create the model instance
3 log_model = LogisticRegression()
4 # 2. Train the model
5 log_model.fit(X_train_cls, y_train_cls)
6 # 3. Make predictions
7 y_pred_cls = log_model.predict(X_test_cls)
8 # 4. Evaluate the model
9 accuracy = accuracy_score(y_test_cls, y_pred_cls)
10 print(f"Accuracy for Survival Prediction: {accuracy:.2%}")

```

Accuracy for Survival Prediction: 74.83%



Knowledge CheckInstructions: Answer the following questions in this markdown cell.

1. In your own words, what is the key difference between a regression problem and a classification problem?

Regression predicts a continuous numerical output (e.g., predicting exact ticket price/fare in dollars or a person age).

Classification predicts discrete categories or labels (e.g., predicting whether a passenger survived [1] or died [0]).

2. The `LinearRegression` model has an attribute called `.coef_`. After you train the model, print `lr_model.coef_`. What do these numbers represent?

`lr_model.coef_` contains the learned coefficients (slopes) for each feature in the regression model.

Each number represents how much the predicted target variable (Fare) changes when that specific feature (Age or Pclass) increases by 1 unit, keeping all other features constant.

3. Why did we use `mean_squared_error` to evaluate the regression model but `accuracy_score` for the classification model? Why wouldn't accuracy be a good metric for the fare prediction task?

`mean_squared_error` measures how far off continuous numerical predictions are from the actual values by averaging the squared differences.

`accuracy_score` measures the proportion of exact correct class labels out of total predictions.

Regression predictions are continuous numbers (e.g., predicting a fare of 32.50 when the actual fare was 32.00). Because exact matches almost never happen with continuous floats, accuracy would effectively be 0%, even if every prediction was off by only a few pennies. Accuracy requires exact categorical matches rather than measuring distance or error magnitude.

1 Start coding or [generate](#) with AI.